

Seventh Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Septima Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: confessed truth, holy fruit, one sacrifice, and healing grace

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus; Quoniam Dominus excelsus, terribilis: Rex magnus super omnem terram</i> (Ps. 46:2–3)	Hands, voice, and the universal King	All nations acclaim with hands and jubilant voice because the Lord is the great King over all the earth.
Collect	<i>Deus, cuius providentia: remove all harms; grant all things profitable</i>	Providence ordering to the good	The Church asks unfailing providence both to remove what injures and to supply what leads toward the good.
Epistle	Rom. 6:19–23	Members, masters, fruit, and ends	Members once presented to impurity are now presented to justice; sanctification is present fruit and eternal life God's gift.
Gradual	<i>Venite, filii, audite me; Accedite ad eum, et illuminamini</i> (Ps. 33:12, 6)	Hearing, fear, and illumination	Children are summoned to hear the fear of the Lord and to approach him for light without shame.
Alleluia	<i>Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus</i> (Ps. 46:2)	Renewed royal acclamation	The Introit's summons returns immediately before Christ's warning about deceptive religious voices.
Gospel	Matt. 7:15–21	Prophets, trees, fruits, and obedience	Claim and clothing do not suffice: works disclose the tree, and entrance belongs to the doer of the Father's will.
Offertory	<i>Sicut in holocaustis arietum</i> (Dan. 3:40)	Humble sacrifice in the furnace	Azariah asks that an offering made in deprivation be accepted like abundant legal victims.
Secret	<i>Legalium differentiam hostiarum unius sacrificii perfectione sanxisti; singuli / cunctis</i>	Many figures, one sacrifice, common profit	God is asked to sanctify the gifts as Abel's, so that what individuals offered for his honor may profit all unto salvation.
Communion	<i>Inclina aurem tuam, accelera, ut eripias me</i> (Ps. 30:3)	Urgent deliverance	The communicant remains a suppliant who asks God to bend near and hasten to rescue.
Postcommunion	<i>Tua nos, Domine, medicinalis operatio</i>	Medicine, release, and right direction	The sacramental operation is asked to free the recipients from perversities and lead them to what is right.
Sense	Synthesis		
Literal	Romans 6 contrasts two services, two fruits, and two ends; Matthew 7 warns against false prophets, tests trees by fruit, and requires the Father's will rather than bare acclamation.		
Allegorical	Christ is the universal King, the true teacher, and the obedient Son. The many legal victims reach their perfection in his one sacrifice, through which the Church offers and receives.		
Moral	Voice must agree with works; doctrine and life must both be tested; the members must be presented to justice; and every offerer must submit to the same healing sought for others.		
Anagogical	The Gospel's fire and kingdom and Paul's death and eternal life disclose final judgment, while medicinal grace is given now to form fruit ordered to life.		

In Illo Tempore...

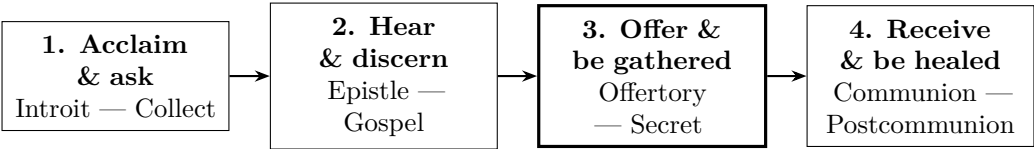
Canonical order governs; proper rows give traditional composition data under Location and Date, the additional Gospel row gives the narrated setting, spanning rows distinguish inherited attribution from historical judgment, and Psalm numbers follow the Vulgate with common modern numbers in parentheses.

Proper	Citation	Location	Date
Communion	Ps. 30:3 (modern 31:3)	Israel; exact place unrecorded	c. 1000 BC
Tradition attributes the lament to David but names no episode or writing site, so it locates it only broadly within his life; its threatened speaker addresses God and then Israel's faithful. Modern scholarship cannot identify its author, date, or place with confidence. Christ later makes its final act of entrustment his own upon the Cross, and Stephen echoes it, carrying suffering Israel's prayer into the Passion and the Church (Ps. 31 and notes, <i>NABRE</i>).			
Gradual	Ps. 33:6, 12 (modern 34:6, 12)	Southern Levant; site unrecorded (Gath / Adullam setting)	c. 1010 BC
The title traditionally attributes the psalm to David after he feigned madness before Achish at Gath, while fleeing Saul before his kingship; the narrative next takes him to Adullam. He addresses learners in wisdom language and the poor. The setting makes the fugitive future king a teacher of other vulnerable people, although modern scholarship cannot recover the historical author, composition place, or date (Ps. 34; 1 Sam. 21:11–22:2).			
Introit / Alleluia	Ps. 46:2–3; 46:2 (modern 47:2–3; 47:2)	Jerusalem sanctuary (traditional association)	c. 1000 BC
The superscription traditionally assigns the hymn to the sons of Korah, the Levitical sanctuary guild associated with worship ordered under David; its biography is corporate: a family preserved in Israel becomes singers in its sanctuary. Israel's assembly is the first audience, but the summons embraces every nation and proclaims the God of Abraham King over all the earth. Modern scholarship cannot securely identify the authorial group, composition place, or date (Ps. 47; Num. 26:11; 1 Chr. 6:16–23).			
Offertory	Dan. 3:40	Babylon, Mesopotamia (present-day Iraq)	c. 540 BC
The traditional row follows the attribution of Daniel to the prophet writing during the Babylonian exile. Within the story, however, Azariah speaks this prayer in the furnace to God for Israel; he is not its penman. With Temple sacrifice unavailable, threatened life becomes humble offering. Modern scholarship treats the Prayer of Azariah as an anonymous Greek addition from a Semitic source, often dated to the persecution of 167–164 BC, with its composition place unknown (Daniel introduction and 3:24–90 note, <i>NABRE</i> ; Hieke, 44–48).			
Gospel	Matt. 7:15–21	Judea / Palestine	c. AD 40–45
<i>Narrated event</i>	Matt. 4:12–5:2; 7:28–29	Unnamed mountain in Galilee	Early public ministry, c. AD 27
Ancient tradition presents St. Matthew writing in the native language of Palestinian Jews for Jewish believers, early in the apostolic mission. The added event row instead locates Jesus, his disciples, and the listening crowds near the end of the Sermon on the Mount. The modern majority regards the final Greek author as unknown, dates the Gospel after AD 70, and locates it plausibly at Antioch; both horizons place Israel's Messiah forming a Church whose confession bears obedient fruit (Matthew introduction, <i>NABRE</i> ; <i>Catholic Encyclopedia</i> , “Gospel of St. Matthew” and “Chronology of the Life of Jesus Christ”).			
Epistle	Rom. 6:19–23	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece)	c. AD 57
Tradition and modern scholarship identify St. Paul as author of Romans, with Tertius serving as scribe, for Jewish and Gentile house churches at Rome which Paul had not yet visited. He had substantially completed his eastern mission and was about to carry the Gentile collection to Jerusalem before seeking Rome's help for Spain; arrest would bring him west in chains instead. Romans 6 locates the baptized within that apostolic expansion: freed from sin for God's service, with sanctification as fruit and eternal life as gift (Romans introduction; Rom. 15:22–29; 16:21–23, <i>NABRE</i>).			

Condensed Authoritative Exposition

Governing thesis: confession must become holy fruit

The Introit and Alleluia repeat Psalm 46’s joining of hands and voice. Augustine reads them as works and confession that must agree. Under God’s kingship and providence, the remaining propers test and heal that concord: grace redirects the members, true hearing approaches Christ, fruit exposes doctrine and life, personal gifts enter one sacrifice for all, and communicants remain patients of divine medicine.



Reading order. This four-stage path is the guide’s source-grounded synthesis of the appointed order. The cited Fathers expound particular texts or doctrines; none is presented as the author of the complete Roman formulary.

1. Acclaim and ask: confession stands under the King (*Int.*, *Coll.*)

The Introit places hands and voice beneath the great King over all the earth; discernment is therefore service, not private sovereignty. The Collect asks unfailing providence to remove harms and grant what profits. St. Thomas teaches that providence is certain without cancelling contingency or free choice (*Summa theologiae* I, q. 22, a. 4). Divine government orders and assists the moral agency demanded by Paul and Christ; it does not replace it.

The inherited key — St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 46*, 2–3

For the verse sung at Introit and Alleluia, Augustine says: “Agree together must the hands and tongue. Let this confess, these work.” He grounds their concord in the kingship of the crucified and ascended Christ, who gathers a people from all nations.

2. Hear and discern: fruit tests religious voice (*Ep.*, *Grad.*, *All.*, *Gosp.*)

The Gradual first supplies the positive pattern: children hear the fear of the Lord and approach him for light. Augustine reads Christ teaching through ministers and the faithful approaching by faith and charity to receive his Body and Blood. The Alleluia then repeats the command to voice-and-hands before Matthew tests prophetic appearance, teaching, conduct, and obedience.

Question	Appointed test	Decisive witness	Boundary
What is true hearing?	The Gradual joins instruction, approach, illumination, and freedom from shame.	Augustine, <i>Psalm 33</i> , 9 and 15, joins Christ’s teaching through ministers to faithful and charitable approach.	Hearing is receptive and sacramental; a teacher’s demeanor alone does not establish truth.
What can fruit show?	Matthew 7 makes the tree visible through fruit and places fire and kingdom under God’s judgment.	Chrysostom sees corrupt life masked by virtue, yet insists that the person can change.	Fruit discloses a present moral state, not an immutable nature, hidden intention, or final verdict.
How are doctrine and life tested?	Saying “Lord, Lord” cannot replace doing the Father’s will; prophetic clothing does not suffice.	Augustine and Jerome test deceptive doctrine and conduct; <i>Didache</i> 11 tests both, while Irenaeus III.3 anchors doctrine in apostolic tradition.	Conduct affects credibility but does not create revelation; true words never excuse a corrupt life.

3. Offer and be gathered: grace-grown fruit enters one sacrifice (*Ep., Off., Sec.*)

The Epistle, Offertory, and Secret move from converted members to humble oblation and from individual gifts to ecclesial profit. Their shared subject is not autonomous achievement but human action received, redirected, and sanctified by grace.

Moment	What the proper establishes	Decisive source-grounded control
Fruit — Epistle	Romans transfers the members from impurity to justice, slavery to sin to service of God, shame to sanctification, and death to eternal life. Death is sin's <i>stipendia</i> ; life is God's <i>gratia</i> .	Chrysostom, <i>Romans</i> 12, distinguishes present holiness from the promised end. Augustine, <i>Grace and Free Will</i> 18–21, says that God crowns works which grace itself enables. Fruit is required, but it is not self-originating merit.
Poverty — Offertory	In Daniel 3, Azariah lacks altar, prince, prophet, and animal victim. He offers a contrite soul and asks that it be received like abundant sacrifices.	The Church therefore approaches as an endangered petitioner, not an accomplished observer displaying its fruit. Humility and trust become the moral body's form at the altar.
One for all — Secret	God perfects the diverse legal victims in one sacrifice, receives gifts as Abel's, and orders what <i>singuli</i> offer toward the salvation of <i>cunctis</i> .	Augustine, <i>City of God</i> X.5–6 and 20, identifies Christ as priest and victim and the Church as his self-offering body. Irenaeus IV.18 makes Abel's righteous heart inseparable from acceptable oblation.

4. Receive and be healed: the discernor remains a patient (*Comm., Postcomm.*)

Communion and Postcommunion — supplication becomes medicine
Communion: “Incline your ear; make haste to deliver me.” Augustine, <i>Psalms</i> 30, 1–4, hears first the humbled Mediator and then his people; the community testing fruit still receives as a petitioner. Postcommunion: God's medicinal operation must release <i>us</i> from perversity and lead <i>us</i> toward right things. Ignatius, <i>Ephesians</i> 20, and Thomas, <i>Summa theologiae</i> III, q. 79, a. 6, illuminate Eucharistic medicine; they do not directly comment on this prayer. Its efficacy strengthens charity without making conversion or vigilance unnecessary.

Four guardrails — the limits should be visible at a glance

- **State is not nature.** A bad tree names a present moral condition; repentance and later failure remain possible.
- **Fruit is not the final verdict.** Manifest teaching and conduct permit prudent judgment, not inspection of the hidden heart or seizure of God's judgment.
- **Credibility is not revelation.** Conduct affects whether a teacher is trustworthy; apostolic truth is not created by personality, and true words do not excuse vice.
- **Grace is not passivity.** Holy fruit and sacramental effects are God's gifts, yet the healed will must still consent, act, persevere, and remain watchful.

Agency throughout — three subjects, one ordered action

God governs, gives eternal life, perfects the sacrifice, delivers, and heals. **The worshipper** confesses, presents the members, hears, tests fruit, offers, and petitions. **The Church** gathers individual gifts for the good of all and receives medicine without placing herself beyond judgment. Thus divine gift and human action, personal offering and ecclesial communion, remain distinct without being separated.

Expansive Authoritative Exposition

The Sunday's lexical structure (*Int., Ep., All., Gosp., Sec.*)

Psalm numbers below follow the Vulgate/Septuagint (modern 47, 34, 31). Four lexical structures carry much of the formulary's sourced unity:

Words	Immediate contrast	Theological work	Limit
<i>voce / manibus</i>	Voice and hands acclaim the King in Psalm 46.	Augustine directly interprets them as confession and good works in concord.	He comments on the psalm, not on this later Mass formulary.
<i>exhibuistis / exhibete</i>	The same members once presented to impurity are now to be presented to justice.	Conversion redirects embodied agency; freedom from one master becomes service to God.	Paul's slavery analogy is explicitly "human" language adapted to the hearers' weakness.
<i>fructum / fructus</i>	Romans names sanctification as fruit; Matthew names deeds as the fruit by which a tree is known.	The repeated noun makes holy conduct both a grace-produced reality and publicly relevant evidence.	A visible act does not disclose every intention or by itself prove doctrine true.
<i>singuli / cunctis</i>	Individuals offer; the Secret asks profit for all.	Personal oblation is ordered to ecclesial salvation within the one sacrifice.	The prayer does not dissolve persons into a collective or make every private intention universally efficacious by itself.

Psalm 46: a concordance of hands and voice (*Int., All.*)

Psalm 46 is an enthronement psalm: the nations are summoned to acclaim because God is the great King over all the earth. The Mass appoints its first command at both Introit and Alleluia and adds the reason at the entrance, *Quoniam Dominus excelsus, terribilis: Rex magnus super omnem terram*. The repeated acclamation is therefore framed by sovereignty, not by applause as self-expression.

Augustine's *Exposition on Psalm 46*, 2–3, supplies an unusually exact inherited bridge. He asks why the nations clap with hands and answers: because of good works. Mouth without active hands is defective; hands without confessing tongue are also defective. The two must agree. He then interprets the King over all the earth christologically: the one mocked and crucified has purchased the world by his blood and ascended as universal King.

Liturgical occurrence	What the text establishes	What Augustine adds
Introit	The whole assembly enters by a command addressed to all nations; hands and jubilant voice act together under the great King.	The bodily action signifies good works and the voice confession; Christ's blood grounds the worldwide people.
Alleluia	The same command is repeated immediately before Matthew's warning about false prophetic appearance and speech.	The inherited demand for agreement supplies a positive standard for the Gospel's negative warning.
Gospel response	Matthew contrasts saying "Lord, Lord" with doing the Father's will.	Augustine's psalm exposition and his Matthew exposition independently insist that a merely vocal confession is incomplete.

The final row synthesizes the appointed contrast of voice and deed with Augustine's direct exposition of each text; it does not attribute the later pairing to him.

Matthew 7: appearance, fruit, doctrine, and judgment (Gosp.)

The immediate context is essential. Jesus has just contrasted the narrow way ending in life with the broad way ending in destruction (Matt. 7:13–14). After the appointed verses he warns that prophecy, exorcism, and wonders done in his name do not replace righteousness (7:22–23), and he closes the sermon with two hearers: one hears and does, building on rock; the other hears and does not, building a ruin (7:24–27). The liturgical pericope stops at verse 21, but the complete paragraph shows why “fruit” cannot mean charisma, visibility, or religious vocabulary alone.

Direct witness	Who is foregrounded?	What counts as fruit?	Guardrail
St. John Chrysostom, Homilies 23–24 on Matthew	In Homily 23 he chiefly distinguishes persons of corrupt life who mask themselves with virtue from open enemies; he does not primarily identify them with heretics.	The difficult, sustained practice of virtue exposes the show; in Homily 24, doing the Father’s will outranks bare confession and even charismatic gifts.	An evil person may become good, but cannot bear good fruit while persisting in evil. Christ commands watchfulness, not private punishment.
St. Augustine, On the Sermon on the Mount II.24–25	He includes heretics and all deceptive seekers of worldly advantage under Christian appearance.	Manifest works of the flesh and fruit of the Spirit matter; trials involving hoped-for gain or feared loss disclose governing love.	Ascetic acts can be costume; hearts remain hidden. A bad teacher’s true doctrine is the vine’s grape gathered through thorns.
St. Jerome, Commentary on Matthew I at 7:15–22	He emphasizes heretics whose fasting, chastity, and restraint conceal poisonous teaching, then turns to orthodox speakers whose lives destroy their teaching.	Doctrine and conduct reciprocally confirm or contradict a claimant.	Moses, Jethro, Judas, and Paul show that “tree” is not an immutable human nature; repentance and fall remain possible.

The differences are real. Chrysostom says that he thinks corrupt hypocrites rather than heretics are foremost; Augustine explicitly includes false claimants to Christian wisdom; Jerome gives heresy special emphasis and then equally insists on moral integrity. The three agree on conversion and on the insufficiency of appearance, but the guide does not flatten their objects into a fabricated consensus.

Three judgments that must not be collapsed

Moral fruit: persistent, manifest action bears on credibility and may require avoidance. **Doctrinal norm:** teaching is measured by apostolic revelation, not generated by the teacher’s attractiveness or vice. **Final judgment:** the fire and the kingdom belong to God; limited human judgment of public words and deeds is not omniscience about the heart. The *Didache* 11 already keeps teaching and conduct as distinct tests, while Irenaeus III.3 identifies the public apostolic succession and preaching as the doctrinal rule.

Romans 6: freedom becomes a gifted service (Ep.)

Romans 6:19–23 concludes an argument begun with baptism into Christ’s death (6:1–11) and continued through the command not to let sin reign in the mortal body (6:12–18). Paul’s slavery comparison is deliberately accommodated to “the infirmity of your flesh.” It is not an endorsement of human slavery or a complete definition of Christian freedom. Its purpose is to deny a supposed neutral zone in which the members serve no governing love.

Pauline hinge	Chrysostom’s direct exegesis	Augustinian doctrinal precision
<i>Exhibuistis / exhibete</i>	Paul asks at least the same earnestness toward the immeasurably better master; the members are truly presented in embodied service.	Grace does not make exhortation fictitious: the healed will truly acts, although its new power and love are gifts.

Pauline hinge	Chrysostom's direct exegesis	Augustinian doctrinal precision
<i>Liberati a peccato, servi autem facti Deo</i>	Liberation, service to righteousness, and holiness are already possessed fruits rather than only distant promises.	Freedom is not independence from God; the works rewarded are God's workmanship enacted by the believer.
<i>Fructum ... in sanctificationem, finem vero vitam aeternam</i>	Present sanctification gives evidence for the future end held in hope; shame and death mark the opposite service.	Eternal life is reward and grace because the good life crowned is itself grace (<i>On Grace and Free Will</i> 18–21).
<i>Stipendia ... mors; gratia ... vita aeterna</i>	Paul refuses parallel terms: death is sin's pay, but life is not described as wages earned from God.	Augustine makes the asymmetry decisive against both boasting and the denial that good works matter.

The same Latin noun, *fructus*, links the Epistle to the Gospel without making the two passages identical. In Matthew, fruit is evidence by which a teacher is known; in Romans, sanctification is the fruit of transferred allegiance and divine liberation. The juxtaposition yields a controlled conclusion: the fruit Christ requires is not a self-created credential, and the gift Paul proclaims is not fruitless permission.

Collect and Gradual: governed, taught, and enlightened (*Coll., Grad.*)

No direct patristic commentary on the Collect was located. Its syntax first confesses that God's *providentia* does not fail *in sui dispositione*, then asks him to remove *noxia* and grant *profutura*. Thomas Aquinas's *Summa theologiae* I, q. 22, a. 4 illuminates the distinction: unfailing providence includes free causes acting freely. The prayer is neither anxiety that God may lose control nor permission to ignore Paul's imperative and Christ's test.

The Gradual answers the question of whose teaching heals perception. Psalm 33:12 calls children to hear the fear of the Lord; verse 6 calls them to approach and be enlightened. Augustine's direct exposition is multilevel but exact. At section 15 he hears Christ as the teacher speaking through ministers. At section 9 he says the nations approach Christ by faith, longing, and the twofold charity of God and neighbor; he explicitly associates the approach with reception of the Crucified's Body and Blood. At section 17, the verses following the Gradual's first line move immediately from hearing to doing: keep the tongue from evil, depart from evil, and do good. True teaching is therefore neither disembodied information nor private suspicion; it draws the hearer toward Christ, charity, sacrament, and action.

Offertory and Secret: deprivation, perfection, and common profit (*Off., Sec.*)

The Offertory is incompletely understood if Daniel 3:40 is isolated from Azariah's furnace prayer. In verses 38–39 there is no prince, prophet, leader, holocaust, sacrifice, oblation, incense, or place to offer first-fruits. The petitioner does not pretend those losses are irrelevant. Instead he asks that contrite soul and humble spirit be received, and then compares the desired acceptance to rams, bulls, and thousands of fat lambs. Verse 41 continues with wholehearted following; verse 42 grounds the plea in God's mercy. Material deprivation becomes neither contempt for liturgy nor confidence in interior sincerity by itself.

While expounding the living sacrifice of Romans 12, Chrysostom cites the furnace prayer and treats eyes, tongue, hands, feet, and hearing as members presented to God rather than retained for selfish use. Read beside Romans 6, this supplies related illumination for embodied self-offering.

The Secret's grammar provides a compact theology:

Clause	Grammatical force	Doctrinal illumination	Boundary
<i>legalium differentiam hostiarum</i>	The legal victims are genuinely diverse.	Augustine, <i>City of God</i> X.20, calls ancient sacrifices various signs of the one true sacrifice.	Diversity of figures does not mean several saving sacrifices parallel to Christ.

Clause	Grammatical force	Doctrinal illumination	Boundary
<i>unius sacrificii perfectione sanxisti</i>	God’s completed act is confessed before the petitions: one sacrifice gives perfection and definitive order.	Christ is priest and victim; the Church offers herself through him.	The Mass does not repeat Calvary as another sacrifice but sacramentally belongs to the one sacrifice.
<i>sicut munera Abel, sanctifica</i>	God is asked to sanctify the present gifts as Abel’s gifts were accepted.	Irenaeus IV.18 joins Abel’s acceptance to righteousness, single-mindedness, and communion with the neighbor.	Moral disposition does not cause the objective sacrifice, but hypocrisy cannot profit by outward correctness.
<i>quod singuli obtulerunt ... cunctis proficiat</i>	A singular relative clause gathers what individuals offered and asks that it profit everyone unto salvation.	Augustine’s redeemed city is offered as one sacrifice through the High Priest (X.6).	The text grounds a personal-to-common movement, not a theory that every private intention has identical effects.

Communion and Postcommunion: the delivered still need cure (*Comm.*, *Postcomm.*)

Psalm 30 moves from trust through urgent rescue to committal of the spirit. Augustine’s *Exposition on Psalm 30*, 1–4, first assigns the voice to the humbled Mediator and then to the people redeemed by his blood. He interprets “bend down your ear” as hearing Christ in humiliation and “make haste to deliver me” within the completion of his body and the final separation from sinners. Whatever one makes of each prosopological detail, the direct exposition blocks a complacent reading: Communion places the Church within Christ’s petitioning voice.

The Postcommunion’s verbs state both release and direction. The operation is God’s; its recipients are *nos*; it loosens them *a nostris perversitatibus* and leads them *ad ea quae sunt recta*. Medicine does not merely cancel an external penalty: it addresses perverse turnings and conducts the will toward right objects and acts.

St. Ignatius and St. Thomas — doctrinal illumination
Ignatius, <i>Ephesians</i> 20, calls the one bread broken in ecclesial unity the “medicine of immortality” and antidote against death. Thomas, <i>Summa theologiae</i> III, q. 79, a. 6, says the Eucharist strengthens spiritual life as food and medicine and guards against sin through union with Christ and the Passion; his reply to the first objection retains the continuing mutability of free will.

The disputed-author *De sacramentis* IV.6.27–28 offers a close liturgical parallel, joining Abel’s gifts, Eucharistic remission, and repeated need for medicine.

The Collect and Postcommunion share a demonstrable direction. The first asks removal of *noxia* and the gift of *profutura*; the last asks release from *perversitates* and guidance to *recta*. The opening petition is answered not by making judgment unnecessary but by asking that sacramental grace heal the judge and doer. The Gospel’s tree can change, as Chrysostom, Augustine, and Jerome all insist; the formulary ends by asking God to effect that change in those who have heard it.

Speculative Exposition

Exploratory mode. These AI-assisted readings are anchored in the appointed propers but are not attributed to the cited authorities and do not establish historical compositional intent.

Praise put on trial. (*Int.*, *All.*, *Gosp.*) The command *Omnes gentes, plaudite manibus* arrives twice. Its return immediately before the wolves and “Lord, Lord” can make the congregation hear its own acclamation differently: the first occurrence announces kingship; the second places the same true words under Christ’s test of clothing, fruit, and obedience. Repetition becomes examination. The question is not only whether the formula is true, but whether the hands named by it accord with the voice. Yet the Alleluia remains unqualified praise, now heard as a claim upon the worshipper rather than evidence that worship is hypocrisy.

The wolf and Abel. (*Gosp., Sec.*) The Gospel’s wolf borrows a sheep’s exterior; the Secret asks that the gifts be sanctified like Abel’s. Abel is shepherd and offerer of firstlings, then the righteous victim of fraternal violence. Read together, the texts set predatory religious appearance beside vulnerable oblation: one dons the flock to consume it; the other gives from the flock and is himself exposed. Discernment then concerns not only whom we fear but what kind of worshipper we are becoming. The proposal stops short of identifying Cain with the wolf or claiming that the formulary itself explicitly joins Abel to Christ’s metaphor.

What profits moves outward. (*Coll., Sec.*) The Collect asks for *omnia nobis profutura*; the Secret asks that what individuals offer *cunctis proficiat*. Their shared language of benefit permits a devotional echo: providence first gives us what helps, then makes individual gifts help all unto salvation. The petitioner’s horizon expands from reception to common benefit. Because *profutura* and *proficiat* are not the same lemma and the Collect’s “us” is already ecclesial, this remains a resonance rather than demonstrated wordplay or a move from the merely private.

The hands enter the sacrifice. (*Int., Ep., Off., Sec.*) The Mass names hands in acclamation; Paul commands the members to be presented to justice; Daniel supplies a contrite offerer amid missing victims; the Secret gathers concrete gifts under one sacrifice. The sequence can be heard as embodied conversion: acclaim becomes service, and service becomes oblation. The hearer does not merely inspect another’s fruit but brings personal agency to the altar. The image supplies no rubric for clapping, and participatory self-offering neither replaces nor becomes identical with Christ’s sacrifice and the sacramental gifts.

Fruit stops being a credential. (*Ep., Gosp., Sec.*) In Romans, fruit is sanctification received under a new service; in Matthew, fruit is evidence for discernment; in the Secret, individual offerings are ordered to the salvation of all. Together they suggest that holy fruit reaches maturity when it is no longer displayed as proof of the self but offered into a good larger than the self. The Gospel’s diagnostic image is carried toward an ecclesial purpose without making virtues Eucharistic matter or promising identical effects from every private intention.

The examiner becomes a patient. (*Grad., Gosp., Comm., Postcomm.*) The Gradual makes the congregation pupils who hear and approach. The Gospel requires them to discern speakers. Communion reverses the acoustic direction: they ask God to incline his ear; Postcommunion confesses “our perversities.” Discernment forms a loop—receive light, test voices, then submit one’s own voice and crookedness to divine hearing and medicine. The competent discerners are precisely the one denied any claim to immunity; the loop intensifies prudent ecclesial judgment rather than negating authority.

Notable Quotables

- Gospel; Ironic exact quotation — *The Night of the Hunter* (dir. Charles Laughton, 1955), opening prologue, 2:27–3:16. Rachel says “by their fruits ye shall know them” as the film cuts from a murdered woman to killer-preacher Harry Powell: verdict first, recognition later.
- Gospel; Witty adaptation — William James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (1902), Lecture I, p. 20. James adds “not by their roots” to Matthew’s test, turning it into a pocket rule for judging religion by results rather than origin stories.
- Epistle; Humorous adaptation — Terry Pratchett, *Witches Abroad* (1991; HarperTorch ed., 2002), p. 282. Romans’ “wages of sin” acquires a “salary of virtue,” followed by the consolation that evil gets Fridays off.
- Introit; Sampled — the Beatles, “Revolution 9,” *The Beatles* (1968), side four, track five. Its tape collage loops Vaughan Williams’s exact Psalm 47 setting *O Clap Your Hands* (1920): the Introit makes a blink-and-you-miss-it avant-garde cameo.

References

Primary sources

- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica (Vatican City: Typis Polyglottis Vaticanis, 1962), *Dominica Septima post Pentecosten*, pp. 386–387, facsimile; publication text visually collated against the page images.
- Internet Archive, *Missale Romanum* (1962) item and OCR locating aid; retrieval data and checksums: [propers/verified.md](#).
- Holy Scripture: Psalm 46 in full; Psalm 33 in full; Psalm 30 in full; Numbers 26:9–11; 1 Samuel 16:1–13 and 21:11–22:2; 1 Chronicles 6:16–23; 2 Chronicles 20:18–19; Daniel 3:24–45; Genesis 4:1–10; Matthew 3:13–5:2 and 7:13–29; Luke 23:46;

Acts 7:59; Romans 6 in full, 12:1–2, 15:22–29, and 16:21–23; Hebrews 9:23–10:18. Psalm numbering follows the Vulgate and missal.

- *Didache* 2, 9–11, 14, especially 11, ANF text; St. Ignatius, *Ephesians* 20, ANF text.
- St. Ambrose (or the Ambrosian author), *De sacramentis* IV.6.27–28, public-domain Latin text; Abel, Eucharistic remission, and medicine.
- St. Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* III.3.1–4, apostolic preaching; IV.18.1–6, Abel and oblation.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homilies 23–24 on Matthew*, on 7:15–27, 23 and 24; *Homily 12 on Romans*, on 6:19–23, text; *Homily 20 on Romans*, on 12:1–2 and Daniel, text.
- St. Jerome, *Commentary on Matthew*, book I, comments on Matthew 7:15–22, Latin text with facing French notes, pp. 80–83; checked paraphrase from the Latin.
- St. Augustine, *Expositions*: Psalm 46, 2–3, text; Psalm 33, 9, 15, 17, text; Psalm 30, 1–4, text. English headings use Psalms 47, 34, and 31.
- St. Augustine, *Sermon on the Mount* II.24.78–81, II.25.82–87, text; *City of God* X.5–6, 20, text; *Grace and Free Will* 18–21, text.
- St. Thomas Aquinas, *Summa theologiae* I, q. 22, a. 4, text; III, q. 79, a. 6, text; English Dominican Province trans., 1920.

Biblical-historical orientation

- *New American Bible, Revised Edition*, introductions to Psalms, Daniel, Matthew, and Romans; texts and notes for Psalms 31, 34, and 47, Daniel 3, Matthew 5, Matthew 7, and Romans 16; USCCB online edition, accessed 2026-07-10.
- *Catholic Encyclopedia*: “Psalms”, “King David”, “Book of Daniel”, and “Gospel of St. Matthew”; witnesses to the traditional authorship, place, and chronology reported in the table’s metadata rows, consulted 2026-07-10.
- *Catholic Encyclopedia*: “Chronology of the Life of Jesus Christ”, for the traditional harmonized placement of the Sermon on the Mount in the early public ministry, and “Mount of Beatitudes”, for the limits on identifying its Galilean mountain; consulted 2026-07-10.
- Thomas Hieke, “Atonement in the Prayer of Azariah (Dan 3:40),” especially pp. 44–48, on textual transmission, post-exilic genre, and the proposed origin during Antiochus IV’s persecution.

Cultural works and verification sources

- *The Night of the Hunter*, dir. Charles Laughton (United Artists, 1955), opening; American Film Institute, synopsis.
- William James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (Longmans, Green, 1902), Lecture I, p. 20, Gutenberg text.
- Terry Pratchett, *Witches Abroad* (HarperTorch, 2002), p. 282; official 1991 publication record.
- The Beatles, “Revolution 9” (Apple, 1968); Vaughan Williams, *O Clap Your Hands* (1920); sample identification in Émilie Crapoulet, “The Beatles and Their Classical Music Connections”. All links accessed 2026-07-10.

Search Scope and Limitations

Compact source panel

Text. All ten propers were collated with the 1962 typical-edition facsimile, pp. 386–387. **Historical orientation.** Six distinct direct biblical passages appear in canonical order; traditional metadata, narrated settings, and historical judgments are distinguished. **Direct reception.** Appointed psalms, Matthew 7, and Romans 6. **Related illumination.** Apostolic testing, providence, sacrifice, Abel, grace-enabled works, and Eucharistic medicine. **Material limits.** Psalm origins, Matthew’s location, and the Prayer of Azariah’s provenance remain partly or wholly disputed; the public survey is not exhaustive of manuscripts, untranslated works, subscription databases, or modern scholarship. **Full records.** `propers/verified.md`; `research/scope.md`.

Generation Metadata

Generated: 2026-07-10

Model: gpt-5.6-sol; reasoning=ultra

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (primary/research/layout review); CLI 0.144.1; API workspace; unexposed: server revision.